

Mahalwari system was devised by Holt Mackenzie in 1822 in the Bengal Presidency. Under this system, the land revenue was collected from the farmers by treating whole village as a single unit called 'Mahal'. The revenue was not fixed but revised periodically.

(c) 1889

(d) 1900

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

In 1793 A.D., Lord Cornwallis introduced permanent settlement which in turn provided many rights to landlords. By the 19th century, the demand for land increased and hence landlords increased the rent of the land which resulted in a revolt by peasants. During this time, the government of Bengal introduced the Bengal and Bihar Tenancy Act 1885, which described the rights of landlords and tenants.

2. Which compensation tax the indigo farmers were required to pay, if they desired exemption from indigo cultivation?

- (a) Batta (b) Jaziya
(c) Tawan (d) Nazrana
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (c)

European planters holding thikadari leases from the big local zamindars forced the peasants to cultivate indigo on part of their Land at un- remunerative prices and by charging Sharahbeshi current enhancement) or Tawan (Lump sum Compensation) if the peasants wanted to be exempted from the obligation of the Indigo cultivation.

3. The 'Permanent Settlement' was made with –

- (a) Zamindars (b) Village communities
(c) Muqaddamas (d) Peasants

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

The Permanent Settlement (1793 A.D.) introduced by Lord Cornwallis also known as Permanent Settlement of Bengal was an agreement between East India Company and Bengali Zamindars to fix revenues to be raised from the land.

4. Which one of the following is correct about the permanent settlement introduced in Bihar.

- (a) The Zamindars were deprived of the ownership of the land.
(b) The right of ownership of land was made hereditary and transferable for the Zamindars.
(c) Land revenue was constitutionalised
(d) Abolition of Zamindari

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

In Bihar, the permanent settlement system ensured a fixed amount of revenue for the company.

5. Fill in the blank:

In the rights of the tenants on land in Bengal and Bihar were given by the Bengal Tenancy Act.

- (a) 1885 (b) 1886

6. The system, under which the peasant himself is the owner of the land and is held responsible for the payment of land revenue to the government is known as?

- (a) Zamindari system
(b) Ryotwari system
(c) Mahalwari system
(d) Dahsala system
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

Under the Ryotwari system, the farmer himself is the owner of the land and the government is held responsible for the payment of land revenue.

7. The Ryotwari system was first implemented in –

- (a) Gujarat (b) Madras
(c) Bombay (d) Odisha
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

The Ryotwari system was first implemented in Madras Presidency by Alexander Reed in 1792 A.D. in the Baramahal region of Tamil Nadu. This system was also implemented in Bombay Presidency. Thomas Munro is related to the Ryotwari system.

Revolt of 1857

1. When was the new Enfield Rifle with greased cartridges introduced in the British Indian Army?

- (a) November, 1856
(b) December, 1856
(c) January, 1857
(d) February, 1857

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

The Company decided to use new Enfield Rifle instead of old Brown Bess gun in December, 1856. The training for the use of this rifle was organized in Dum Dum, Ambala, and Sialkot. The rifle needed an extraordinary kind of loading of a cartridge in the magazine and hence the soldiers while in the ensuing fight, had to bite off the outer covering of the cartridge while loading it down into the rifle's muzzle. The cartridge was rumoured to have been greased with animal fat (Pig fat and Cow fat). Army Commanders refused rumours without any cross-checking, but the soldiers were of the view that this was an intentional act of the British to besmirch their religion. This became the immediate cause first Independence Struggle of India in 1857.

2. Which of the following was not a reason for making the sepoys of the East India Company rebellious?

- (a) The efforts of the officers of the company to spread Christianity
- (b) The order to the sepoys to travel on ships
- (c) The stoppage of Bhatta
- (d) The inefficiency of the officers
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

The inefficiency of the officers was not a cause for the sepoy Mutiny. The Indian Rebellion of 1857 occurred as a result of an accumulation of factors over time, rather than any single event, like an effort of officers to spread Christianity among the soldiers led to interference in the religious matters of the people. The order of the Company to the sepoys to travel on a ship was another reason as in Hinduism it was believed that travelling on the sea can devoid them of their religious status of being a Hindu. A more immediate cause of the sepoy's dissatisfaction was the recent order that they would not be given the foreign service allowance (Bhatta/Batta) when serving in Sindh or Punjab and rumours of the use of animal fat in the cartridges of the New Enfield Rifle.

3. Which of the following were the reasons for the failure of the Revolt of 1857?

- 1. The military superiority of the British
- 2. The rebels did not have a unified programme and ideology
- 3. There was a lack of support from all the sections of society

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) Only 1 and 2
- (b) Only 2 and 3

- (c) All of the above
- (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Where from the Revolution of 1857 started first?

- (a) Lucknow
- (b) Allahabad
- (c) Jhansi
- (d) Meerut
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

The first war of Independence was started from Meerut. Sepoys refused to use the new rifle cartridges and revolted openly. They left Meerut and moved to Delhi. Major General William Hewitt had not tried to stop this rebellion. Lieutenant General George Dobson Precival Willoughby resisted, but he was defeated. Mughal Emperor Bahadur Shah Zafar was declared as Emperor of India. The success of Delhi revolt sensitized many parts of India and revolt spread over to the areas of Oudh (Awadh), Rohilkhand, Western Bihar, etc.

5. At Delhi, during the Revolt of 1857, the nominal and symbolic leadership belonged to the emperor Bahadur Shah, but the real command lay with a court of soldiers headed by

- (a) Nana Saheb
- (b) Bakht Khan
- (c) Hazrat Mahal
- (d) None of the above

BPSC Agriculture Department-2024

Ans. (b)

At Delhi, during the Revolt of 1857, the nominal and symbolic leadership belonged to the emperor Bahadur Shah, but the real command lay with a court of soldiers headed by General Bakht Khan.

6. Who was the English Officer-in- Charge of Delhi at the time of the Revolt of 1857?

- (a) General Hewett
- (b) Lieutenant Hodson
- (c) Lieutenant Willoughby
- (d) John Nicholson
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (e)

During the revolt of 1857, Bahadur Shah Zafar was the leader at Delhi. He was proclaimed Emperor of Hindustan on 11th May, 1857 by mutineers in Delhi. However Delhi was recaptured by 20 September, 1857 by General John Nicholson who also succumbed to his injuries on 23rd September, 1857. After that Lieutenant John Hodson captured the king and taken him as prisoner.

7. The first woman President of the Indian National Congress was

- (a) Sarojini Naidu (b) Annie Besant
- (c) Kasturba Gandhi (d) Aruna Asaf Ali
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

Annie Besant was selected as the first woman president of the Indian National Congress in 1917.

8. Who was the first woman President of the Indian National Congress?

- (a) Kasturba Gandhi (b) Annie Besant
- (c) Kamala Nehru (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 9-10) 07-12-2023

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

9. The female freedom fighter popularly known as the 'Grand Old Lady' of the Independence Movement was

- (a) Aruna Asaf Ali
- (b) Gulab Kaur
- (c) Bishni Devi Shah
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift I

Ans. (a)

Aruna Asaf Ali, popularly known as the Grand old lady of the Independence Movement was a fearless revolutionary from Punjab who played a significant role in the Quit India Movement.

10. Which of the following persons had participated actively in the Revolt of 1857?

- (a) Nana Saheb (Kanpur)
- (b) Begum Hazrat Mahal (Lucknow)
- (c) Maulavi Ahmadullah (Faizabad)
- (d) Begum Zeenat Mahal (Delhi)
- (e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (e)

1857 rebellion is also known as First War of Indian Independence. Most of the leaders & kings of that time participated in the war, like Rani Laxmi Bai of Jhansi, Tantia Tope, Nana Saheb of Kanpur, Begum Hazrat Mahal of Lucknow and many more.

11. The revolt of 1857 at Lucknow was led by :

- (a) Begum of Oudh (b) Taty Tope
- (c) Rani Lakshmibai (d) Nana Saheb

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

The revolt was started on 30 May, 1857 in Oudh (Lucknow). The mutiny was led by Begum Hazrat Mahal. She crowned her minor son Birjis Qadir as royal heir and took charge of the affair of the state of Oudh. Later British General Campbell reannexed Lucknow with the help of Gorkha regiment on 21 March, 1858.

12. Where did Lord Sinha resign from the post of Governor in 1921?

- (a) Bihar-Odisha (b) Bengal
- (c) Punjab (d) Madras

53th to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

Satyendra Prasanna Sinha was born on March 24, 1863 in Raipur, Birbhum, in Bengal Presidency. He was the first Indian to be appointed Advocate General of Bengal in the year 1905 A.D. He was the first Indian to be inducted as a legal member of the Viceroy's Council, Appointed as the Governor of Bihar and Orissa in the year 1920, the first Indian to hold a high post in the administration. Due to health reasons, he resigned from his post in the year 1921. He died on March 4, 1928.

13. Who spearheaded the 1857 Revolt in Bihar ?

- (a) Nana Saheb (b) Taty Tope
- (c) Kunwar Singh (d) Maulavi Ahmadullah
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

Kunwar Singh was one of the most important freedom fighters in the Sepoy Mutiny of 1857. Kunwar Singh was born in Jagdishpur in the Shahabad (now in Bhojpur District) of Bihar. He belonged to Arrah in Bihar during the mutiny. When the people of all parts of India rose against British authority in 1857, Babu Kunwar Singh was nearly eighty years old. In that age, he fought against the English East India Company. Despite his age and failing health, Kunwar Singh plunged into the thick of it and battled against the British forces with grim determination and undaunted courage. In Bihar, Kunwar Singh was the Leader against the British. He assumed command of the soldiers who had revolted at Danapur on 25th July, 1857. Two days later he occupied Arrah, the district headquarters. Major Vincent Eyre relieved

the town on 3rd August, defeated Kunwar Singh's force and destroyed Jagdishpur. Kunwar Singh left his ancestral village and reached Lucknow in December 1857. In March 1858, he occupied Azamgarh. However, he had to leave the place soon. He was pursued by Brigadier Douglas, and he retreated towards his home in Bihar. On 23 April, 1858 Kunwar Singh had a victory near Jagdishpur over the force led by Captain Le Grand, but on 26 April, 1858 the following day he died in his village. The mantle of the old chief now fell on his brother Amar Singh who, despite heavy odds, continued the struggle and for a considerable time ran a parallel government in the district of Shahabad (Now Bhojpur). In October 1859 Amar Singh joined the rebel leaders in the Nepal Terai.

14. Where did Kunwar Singh join the Rebellion of 1857 against the British?

- (a) Arrah (b) Patna
(c) Bettiah (d) Varanasi
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

According to BPSC the correct answer is option (b) which is wrong. For the detailed explanation refer to the above question.

15. Who said, "Wherever I am, there is Jagdishpur"?

- (a) Amar Singh (b) Jhansi ki Rani
(c) Kunwar Singh (d) General Lloyd
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (c)

Kunwar Singh said "Wherever I am, there is Jagdishpur". He was a leader and military commander during the Indian Rebellion of 1857.

16. Who was the leader of revolutionaries in Bihar during the Revolt of 1857?

- (a) Namdar Khan (b) Babu Kunwar Singh
(c) Birsa Munda (d) Shankar Shah
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

17. Who led the Revolt of 1857 in Bihar?

- (a) Khan Bahadur Khan (b) Kunwar Singh

(c) Taty Tope

(d) Rani Ramkunvari

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

18. Who was the commander of the British army sent against Kunwar Singh during the 1857 Revolt?

- (a) General Hewitt (b) Sir Colin Campbell
(c) Sir Hugh Rose (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. Headmaster 07-12-2023

Ans. (e)

The rebellion in Bihar was led by Babu Kunwar Singh. He was nearly 80 when he took charge of the sepoys who were placed at Danapur on 25th July, 1857. Singh and his troops laid an attack on the district headquarters at Arrah. He held the fort for 7 days when British Officer Major Vincent Eyre took Arrah back.

19. The Mutiny of 1857 at Patna was led by a dynamic old person known as:

- (a) Hyder Ali Khan (b) Rajput Kunwar Singh
(c) Judhar Singh (d) Kusal Singh

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

The mutiny of 1857 at Patna was led by Zamindar Kunwar Singh. He lost his Zamindari due to British policies, as a result, he participated in 1857 revolt.

20. The centre of 1857 revolt in Bihar from 15th July, 1857 to 20th January, 1858 was:

- (a) Rampur (b) Hamirpur
(c) Dheerpur (d) Jagdishpur

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

The centre of 1857 revolt was Jagdishpur in Bihar where Zamindar Kunwar Singh led and established his own government by deposing British Government. Bihar revolt was suppressed by Commissioner of Patna William Taylor and Major Vincent Eyer.

21. Which person of Jagdishpur took the lead of revolutionaries during the revolt of 1857 A.D.

- (a) Kunwar Singh (b) Chandra Shekhar

- (c) Tirath Singh (d) Ram Singh

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

22. The king of Jagdishpur was

- (a) Nana Saheb (b) Taty Tope
(c) Lakshmi Bai (d) Kunwar Singh

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

23. One of the leaders of the Revolt of 1857 AD, Kunwar Singh was related to which place?

- (a) Gwalior (b) Jagdishpur
(c) Jhansi (d) Meerut
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

24. Who of the following was the bitterest enemy of the British during the Revolt of 1857?

- (a) Maulavi Ahmadullah Shah
(b) Maulavi Imadadullah
(c) Maulana Fazi-i-Haq Khairabadi
(d) Nawab Liaquat Ali

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

Maulavi Ahmadullah Shah was the bitterest enemy of Britishers. He led the 1857 revolt in Faizabad. He was basically from Arkot (Tamil Nadu), but later he resided in Faizabad (Now Ayodhya). The British considered him a worthy enemy and a great warrior in following words "as a man of great abilities of undaunted courage, of stern determination and by far the best soldiers among the rebels".

25. The Revolt of 1857 was witnessed by the poet –

- (a) Mir Taqi Mir (b) Zauq
(c) Ghalib (d) Iqbal

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

Mirza Ghalib was a poet who witnessed the revolt of 1857.

26. Which of the following groups did not participate in the revolt of 1857?

1. Agricultural Labour 2. Sahukar
3. Farmers 4. Landlords

Select your answer from the following codes :

- (a) Only 1 (b) 1 and 2
(c) Only 2 (d) 2 and 4

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

The revolt of 1857 was widespread and this rebellion had the popular support of the public. But it was suppressed to a greater extent. It was spread in limited areas. The entire South India, Punjab and the territory towards its north and west Rajasthan, Gujarat and Madhya Pradesh remained out from the revolt. Many native rulers like the rulers of Patiala, Jind, Gwalior, Hyderabad, Sikhs of Punjab helped the British in suppressing the revolt by all possible means. The money lenders and merchants were also against the war as it was against their economic benefits. The educated Indians and the middle class also did not support the revolt. On the contrary, their feelings were against it.

27. The Phulka Rebellion of 1816 in Punjab was led by

- (a) Kharak Singh (b) Banda Singh Bahadur
(c) Bhagat Singh (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (e)

None of the provided options accurately represent the leader of the Phulka Rebellion of 1816 in Punjab. As such option '(e) – None of the above ' is the correct answer.

28. Who among the following did not rebel against the British East India Company's control over them?

- (a) Raja of Vijayanagar
(b) Nizam of Hyderabad
(c) Polygar of Tamil Nadu
(d) Dewan Velu Thampi of Travancore
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

All of the above (Raja of Vijayanagar, Polygar of Tamil Nadu and Dewan Velu Thampi of Travancore) except the Nizam of Hyderabad rebelled against the British East India Company's control over them.

29. Which part of Bihar was unaffected with the revolt of 1857?

- (i) Danapur (ii) Patna
(iii) Arrah (iv) Muzaffarpur
(v) Munger

Choose the correct answer from the code given below:

- (a) iv and v (b) Only v
(c) Only iv (d) iii, iv and v

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

Arrah, Danapur, Gaya, Patna, Muzaffarpur and Bhojpur were major centres of revolt in Bihar while the region of Munger was unaffected from the revolt of 1857.

30. Who was the Governor-General of India in 1857?

- (a) Wellesley (b) Dalhousie
(c) Canning (d) Minto

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Lord Canning was Governor General of India during 1857 revolt. Lord Canning was last Governor General of the Company in India and the first Viceroy appointed by British Crown. Indian High Court Act 1861 introduced judicial reforms and established High Court in Bombay, Calcutta, and Madras in the tenure of Canning. In the field of social, reform, Widow Remarriage Act, 1856 was passed during the tenure of Lord Canning.

31. What was the main cause of the failure of the revolt of 1857?

- (a) Lack of Hindu-Muslim unity
(b) Lack of common strategy and central organization
(c) Its effect was within a limited area
(d) Non-participations of Landlords

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

The revolt of 1857 failed due to lack of a common strategy and central organization. This was one of the major reasons of the failure of the revolt of 1857. All the groups participated in this revolt for their interests. There was no feeling of nationalism behind the mutiny and lack of clear vision.

32. Consider :

Assertion (A) : The first war of Independence in 1857 failed to secure freedom from the British Government.

Reason (R) : The leadership of Bahadur Shah Zafar did not have popular support and most of the Indian rulers of important States shied away from the struggle.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, and (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Both (A) and (R) are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. There were various reasons for the failure of the First War of Independence in 1857, but the most important reason was the support of native kings of major territories to the British.

33. Who called the revolt of 1857 a conspiracy?

- (a) Sir James Outram and W. Taylor
(b) Sir John K.
(c) Sir John Lawrence
(d) T.R. Homes

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

Sir James Outram and W. Taylor observed that the revolt of 1857 was the result of a Hindu-Muslim conspiracy. Outram observed that it was a Muslim conspiracy that took advantage of Hindu grievances. According to John Celey, it was a 'Sepoy Mutiny' while J.R. Holmes expressed that it was a conflict between civilization and barbarism.

34. When did Queen Victoria declare the taking over of Indian Administration under British crown?

- (a) 1 Nov. 1858 (b) 31 Dec. 1857
(c) 6 Jan. 1958 (d) 17 Nov. 1859

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

In the aftermath of 1857 revolt, East India Company's rule ended in India and the reign was handed over to Queen Victoria by a proclamation announced on November 1, 1858. She assumed the responsibility of the Indian administration in her hand. Hence, the option (a) is correct.

35. Queen Victoria's Proclamation was issued on which of the following dates?

- (a) 1 November, 1857
(b) 27 March, 1858
(c) 1 November, 1858
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (c)